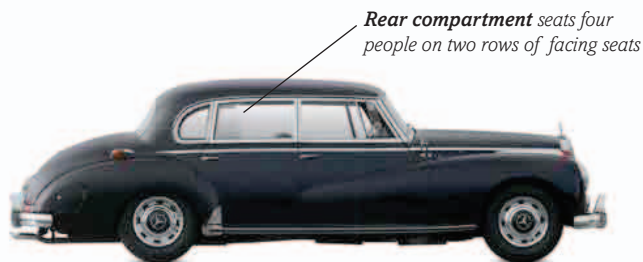




Fins and finery



Mercedes-Benz 300 Germany 1951

Rear compartment seats four people on two rows of facing seats



Cadillac Series 62 Club Coupé USA 1952

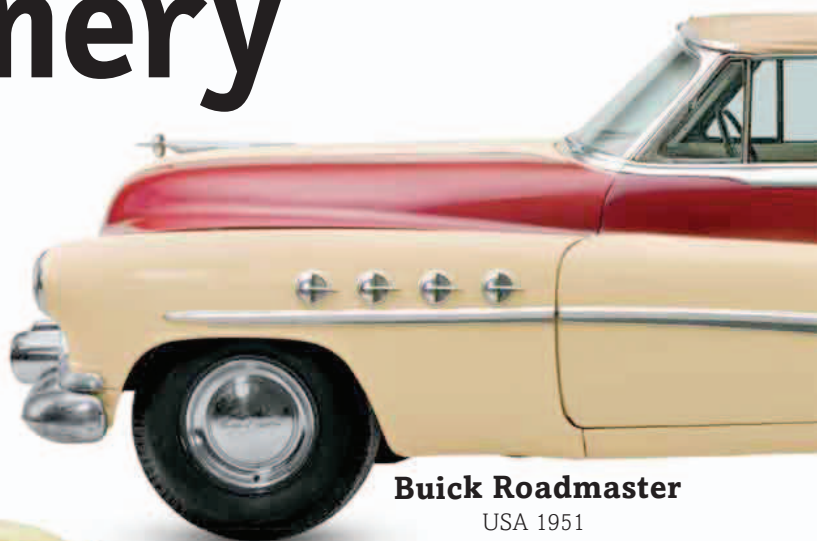
Armstrong Siddeley Sapphire UK 1953



Front doors open at the back, the opposite way of the rear doors

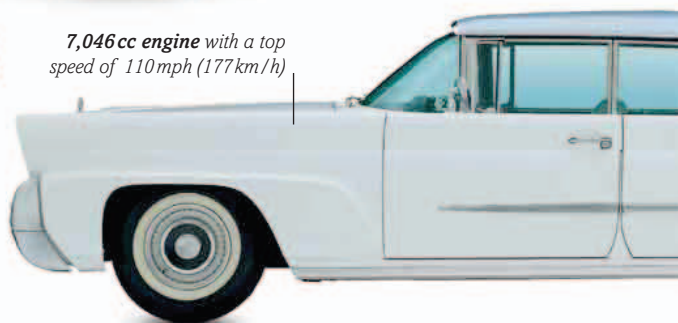
Large tail fin rises up from main body

Big fins were pioneered by Cadillac



Buick Roadmaster USA 1951

7,046cc engine with a top speed of 110mph (177km/h)



Large tailfin contains the gas cap of the 23-gal (87-liter) gas tank



Chrysler New Yorker USA 1957



Studebaker Silver Hawk USA 1957



The 1950s saw an incredible economic boom in the USA; 30 million more cars had taken to its roads by the end of the decade. Cars went from everyday transportation to chrome-covered status symbols, packed with innovative new features.

Germany's first postwar luxury car, the **Mercedes-Benz 300**, seated six people and was called the **Adenauer** after the West German chancellor who installed a writing desk inside one of his 300s. In contrast, the American **Buick Roadmaster** was a riot of two-tone color and